5, 1973. But the Mossad chief's important role during the war remains almost completely unknown."

The status of the Mossad and its director was undermined when the warning of war in April–May 1973, which I have referred to in this chapter as "Time B," was not realized. According to Tsoref, "During the war, and as the days passed, the standing of the Mossad and its chief grew stronger and stronger. This process was likely influenced by the failure of Military Intelligence, headed by Eli Zeira, to predict the outbreak of the war. This is how the head of the Mossad became Prime Minister Golda Meir's chief adviser on intelligence affairs, especially during the final stages of the war. Without him, no decisive strategic decision was made. Zamir was in the Prime Minister's Office almost daily and participated in many of the consultations held there."

According to Tsoref, the Mossad, headed by Zamir, played an important role throughout the war in a number of areas:

1. Zamir met with Marwan twice more during the period under discussion, and the information he brought from these meetings played an important role in directing the government's diplomatic moves vis-à-vis the Americans and the Egyptians.
2. From the beginning of the war, Zamir warned that the IDF had not fully understood the change that the Egyptians had made to the war plan near its outset, which led to the IDF planners beginning to respond to these changes accordingly. This change had to do with the war's objective, which at first was ambitious and involved crossing the Canal and rapidly progressing to Mitla Pass; on the eve of the war the objective was modified to breaching the Suez Canal and capturing a narrow strip of ten kilometers to its east.
3. The intelligence information Zamir provided to the leadership saved Israel from major military threats.

This last statement refers to Zamir's advice regarding counter-attacks and the crossing of the Canal. Already on the night of October 7, at a meeting in Golda's office, Zamir warned against embarking on a counterattack on the southern front on the following day, October 8. Zamir is quoted as saying, "The Egyptians are waiting for exactly such an attack